

# AntiDoomscroll

Reclaiming Time and Focus from Algorithmic Feeds

## SOFTWARE PRODUCT PITCH

### The Problem:

Users often pick up their phones for a quick, specific task, but end up losing hours trapped in addictive, infinite-scrolling video feeds without realizing how much time has passed, how many videos they have watched, or how to break the involuntary loop.

### The Idea:

AntiDoomscroll is an intelligent mobile well-being application that turns unconscious, passive content consumption into conscious, step-by-step digital moderation through proactive cognitive pauses and friction checkpoints.

## TARGET IMPACT

**Primary SDG: SDG 3 – Good Health and Well-Being**

# 1. The Problem We Want to Solve

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Short-form algorithmic video platforms (TikTok, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts) are engineered with variable reward schedules that actively override natural self-regulation. Unlike traditional media formats with defined stopping points, infinite-scroll engines remove natural boundaries, making disengagement difficult for students, professionals, and daily smartphone users.

A user caught in a doomscroll loop often experiences:

- How long have I been scrolling?
- Why did I open this app in the first place?
- How many micro-videos have I watched in this single sitting?
- How do I stop without having to delete the application completely?
- Why do I feel mentally exhausted, depleted, and anxious afterward?
- Did I miss my study window, work deliverable, or intended bedtime?

The intent to stop exists, but standard built-in screen timers are passive, easily dismissed with a single tap, or bypassed entirely. AntiDoomscroll aims to replace passive tracking with active, friction-based behavioral checkpoints.

## 2. Our Solution

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AntiDoomscroll is a real-time behavioral intervention application focused specifically on interrupting compulsive short-form feed consumption. Users define their session parameters and friction triggers. AntiDoomscroll monitors continuous scrolling and deploys progressive, mindful pauses.

***AntiDoomscroll answers the entire digital-habit question:***

***What app am I stuck in? How long have I scrolled? Why am I here? What should I do instead? How do I exit smoothly?***

## 3. How AntiDoomscroll Works

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The user establishes targeted applications and intervention thresholds.

### 1. ENTER TARGETS

Configure target applications and daily continuous scroll limits.

### 2. DETECT SCROLL VELOCITY

Monitors swipe speed and continuous feed duration locally.

### 3. TRIGGER COGNITIVE PAUSE

Deploys an inescapable, calm friction overlay over the feed.

### 4. COMPLETE CHALLENGE

Requires a mandatory 5-second breath or mindful text reflection.

### 5. REDIRECT HABIT

Offers 1-tap exit to intentional apps: reading, tasks, or sleep.

### 6. RECLAIM FOCUS

An optional 'Focus Shield' mode locks out feeds during night or study.

## 4. Example User Journey

Scenario: Opening Instagram to respond to a Direct Message at 10:30 PM

| Step  | AntiDoomscroll Recommendation & Intervention                          | User Outcome                     |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 1     | Daemon identifies sudden transition from DMs into infinite Reels feed | User starts passive scrolling    |
| 2     | 10-minute continuous scroll threshold is reached                      | Gentle haptic alert vibrates     |
| 3     | Screen dims; full-screen cognitive breath checkpoint appears          | Compulsive swipe loop broken     |
| 4     | Prompt asks: <i>"Did you find what you originally came here for?"</i> | User realizes aimless state      |
| 5     | App displays Exit / 5-Min Extension / Open Kindle Reader options      | User selects "Close Application" |
| Total | 1 conscious cognitive friction intervention                           | Bedtime routine saved            |

**Result:** Instead of losing an unintended 45 minutes to an algorithm, the user receives one clear, dignified checkpoint and returns to intentional living.

## 5. Core Features

|                          |                                                                                        |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scroll Velocity Detector | Differentiates between intentional reading and compulsive micro-video flicking.        |
| Cognitive Checkpoints    | Replaces dismissible alerts with active friction (deep breathing or typed reflection). |
| Intent Prompts           | Grounds the user with reflective prompts before unlocking any feed extension.          |
| Habit Redirection Deck   | Provides 1-tap jump shortcuts to constructive apps (Kindle, notes, task boards).       |
| Scroll Budget Tracker    | Tracks cumulative swipes, session counts, and hours reclaimed daily.                   |
| Diminishing Extensions   | Permits emergency time but progressively increases friction to prevent bingeing.       |
| Nighttime Strict Shield  | Enforces strict lockouts during preset sleep and deep-work hours.                      |
| Privacy-First Engine     | Runs 100% locally on-device without tracking viewing history or personal data.         |

## 6. What Makes AntiDoomscroll Different?

AntiDoomscroll is not trying to compete with passive parental control apps or post-hoc screen-time trackers that simply report hours after the loss of focus has occurred. Its design is centered on **\*\*active, real-time behavioral intervention\*\***.

Its unique advantage is the synthesis of: **\*\*velocity detection + mandatory friction challenges + intentional reflection prompts + instant habit redirection\*\*** in one unified user workflow.

The initial release runs locally via accessibility frameworks, ensuring complete offline autonomy without requiring external telemetry or account creation.

## 7. Who Benefits?

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- **Students:** Drastically reduces study-session interruptions and improves academic retention.
- **Young Professionals:** Eliminates workday procrastination rabbit holes and afternoon mental drain.
- **Nighttime Smartphone Users:** Protects sleep hygiene by removing late-night algorithmic rabbit holes.
- **Daily Device Users:** Eliminates post-scroll guilt and creates a balanced relationship with mobile apps.
- **Educators & Counselors:** A tangible, ethical tool to recommend to learners facing digital dependency.

## 8. Why This Matters

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Human attention and mental clarity are finite resources. A social platform provides entertainment, but when UX patterns eliminate stopping cues entirely, consumption becomes involuntary. AntiDoomscroll helps restore agency to personal technology use.

By interrupting continuous dopamine-seeking loops, AntiDoomscroll empowers individuals to make intentional choices about how they invest their time, focus, and creativity.

## 9. SDG Connection

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### SDG 3 – Good Health and Well-Being

AntiDoomscroll directly champions mental wellness by reducing anxiety, sleep disruption, and cognitive fatigue associated with compulsive short-form video feeds.

**Additional SDG connections:**

- **SDG 4 – Quality Education:** Enhances focus and reduces digital fragmentation for learners during study periods.
- **SDG 8 – Decent Work and Economic Growth:** Restores deep-work capacity and professional productivity.
- **SDG 9 – Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure:** Demonstrates human-centered, privacy-preserving software design.

## 10. Future Potential

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- Context-aware study zones using geofencing and campus Wi-Fi network triggers.
- AI-assisted sentiment detection to intercept emotionally distressing doomscrolling spirals.
- Peer accountability circles where study groups celebrate collective hours reclaimed.
- Wearable biometrics integration triggering breathwork when elevated stress is detected during screen sessions.
- Full offline-first, zero-telemetry architecture for sensitive organizational environments.

## 11. The Vision

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Our vision is simple: **make technology a conscious tool, not a compulsive habit.**

AntiDoomscroll aims to become an essential daily companion that reminds users not just when to put their phone down, but how to reclaim their time and attention for what truly matters in their real lives.

**AntiDoomscroll**

*Own your attention. Break the loop. Live with intention.*